

DREAM

To beat television and make radio popular not just for music, but as a tool of knowledge

22, and Aloysius, 24—he feels like Jamal Malik of *Slumdog Millionaire*. “My life has changed and I have an opportunity to talk to the nation,” he says. His colleague, RJ Kaushi, is from Delhi and struggled initially to speak fluent Tamil. Now she says, she can’t seem to stop. Daughter of a TRAI official, she doesn’t want youngsters to be spoon-fed by the parents, “Decide for yourself and lead your own life.” Her favourite slogan, what you see is what you get, or as she says, WYSIWYG. For them, FM’s not just about music. “We are trying to make it a tool of knowledge,” says Lavanya, who anchors two weekly shows. “We are innovative and others copy us,” says RJ Aloysius. The son of government servants, he has no intention of following in their footsteps. Like Freddie Mercury, he wants to break free.

by Mahalingam Ponnusamy



(FROM LEFT)
KAUSHI, GIRISH,
LAVANYA,
ALOYSIUS

“Like A.R. Rahman and Resul Pookutty, I too want to win an Oscar but for direction.”

P.I. SIDDIQUE Filmmaker



SIDDIQUE (SECOND FROM RIGHT)

Student Filmmakers Thrissur, Kerala

Hand Crafted

The story about four film-crazy teenagers from a village in Thrissur, Kerala, could well qualify as a movie script. Their passion to make a movie was so fierce that with no money to buy or even hire a video camera, they went ahead and made it with a cellphone. This led to the birth of the first cellphone documentary in Malayalam—the 19-minute-long *Tora* on the unknown Jewish traditions of their village Mala.

“Even the Nokia 6233 which we used was borrowed from a friend,” says P.I. Siddique, 19, *Tora*’s director and a final year student of BCom at St. Theresa’s College, Thrissur. Later, they made another film *Talmud* on the same subject with a nine-megapixel handycam. Their biggest project, *A Farmer’s Sorrow*, a touching film on farmer suicides, featured Siddique’s father in the lead. The four-and-a-half minute film, shot on a budget of Rs 500, made it to many short-film festivals in Kerala and also won

Siddique the best director award. His team? Seventeen-year-old K. Ranjit who worked the camera for the first time; Anzar Majeed, 17, an assistant at a local studio who was the editor and music composer; and Aslam, 17, who assisted in all departments and even sang for the film.

The four have now formed a group called Creative Boys and recently completed a cellphone film *Who Loves You*, which they have uploaded for a mobile movie competition being held by the Manorama Online edition. “No girl from our college was willing to act in it. But since it was a love story, we badly needed one. So we made the absence of the girl appear more poignantly romantic,” says Siddique, who proudly says that he is now accepted as a filmmaker and is getting requests from many actors. Yes, even women.

by M.G. Radhakrishnan

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To make movies with a message

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